

# THE WORLD OF LIMITLESS POSSIBILITIES

Class 9 English – Kaveri | Chapter 5 | Interview with Dr. Deepa Malik

## Detailed Textbook Solutions + Exam-Oriented Practice

Chapter 5 presents an interview with Dr. Deepa Malik, the Indian para-athlete whose journey illustrates determination, resilience, inclusion and the idea that ability can extend far beyond physical limitation. Current 2026–27 Kaveri references identify this as Chapter 5 and pair it with David Roth's "Nine Gold Medals". ■cite■turn0search1■turn0search6■

# 1. CHAPTER INFORMATION

| Item                 | Details                                                                                             |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Text type            | Interview                                                                                           |
| Subject              | Dr. Deepa Malik – para-athlete and advocate                                                         |
| Main focus           | Her life after paralysis, sporting achievements, resilience and advocacy                            |
| Key ideas            | Self-belief, determination, inclusion, accessibility, women's participation, overcoming stereotypes |
| Important phrase     | "Ability beyond disability"                                                                         |
| Related sports event | Paralympic Games; Rio 2016                                                                          |

## 2. IMPORTANT BACKGROUND

The chapter introduces the Paralympic movement and then uses an interview format to explore Dr. Deepa Malik's personal journey. The interview discusses the spinal tumour that left her paralysed waist-down, her transition into para-sport, her Rio 2016 silver medal, recognition through major Indian awards, and her work encouraging inclusion and opportunities for others. ■cite■turn0search8■turn0search11■

## 3. IMPORTANT TERMS

| Term          | Meaning                                                                       |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| para-athlete  | an athlete who competes in para-sport                                         |
| Paralympics   | major international multi-sport games for eligible athletes with disabilities |
| resilience    | ability to recover, adapt and continue despite difficulty                     |
| locomotor     | relating to movement or the ability to move                                   |
| inclusion     | ensuring that people can participate equally and meaningfully                 |
| advocacy      | public support for a cause or group                                           |
| empowerment   | helping people gain confidence, opportunity and control                       |
| accessibility | designing places/services so people with different needs can use them         |
| stereotype    | a fixed and oversimplified belief about a group                               |
| setback       | a difficulty that delays or obstructs progress                                |

## 4. REFLECT AND RESPOND

### Q1. What do you notice about the athlete's determination in the picture of Sheetal Devi?

The athlete's posture, concentration and commitment suggest strong determination. The image can be read as an example of an athlete focusing on skill and performance rather than allowing physical limitations to define her possibilities. Sheetal Devi was honoured with the Arjuna Award in January 2024. ■cite■turn1view0■

### Q2. What challenges might a para-athlete have faced?

A para-athlete may have faced physical barriers, inaccessible facilities, limited equipment, social stereotypes, financial constraints, intensive training demands and the need to adapt techniques to individual abilities.

### Q3. Suggest a suitable caption.

**"Aiming Beyond Limits" / "Ability Beyond Disability".**

### Q4. Can achievements of para-athletes inspire society?

Yes. Their achievements can challenge stereotypes, encourage wider participation in sport, increase awareness of accessibility and show that disability does not by itself determine a person's potential.

## 5. PARALYMPICS – WHAT I KNOW / WANT TO KNOW

| What I Know                                                                         | What I Want to Know                                   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| They are international sports competitions for eligible athletes with disabilities. | How are athletes classified and selected?             |
| They include many sporting disciplines.                                             | What training and accessibility support is available? |
| Indian para-athletes have won international medals.                                 | Which sports have produced major Indian successes?    |
| They promote sporting participation and inclusion.                                  | How can schools encourage inclusive sport?            |

## 6. CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

### I. Fact table – key answers

| Fact asked in textbook                                | Answer                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Age when Dr. Malik was diagnosed with a spinal tumour | 29                                                                                                                    |
| Effect of surgery                                     | She became paralysed waist-down and used a wheelchair                                                                 |
| Global recognition mentioned                          | Named among the world's 10 most inspirational women para-athletes by the International Paralympic Committee           |
| Major 2016 achievement                                | Silver medal in shot put at the Rio Paralympic Games                                                                  |
| Important sporting firsts                             | First Indian female para-athlete to win an Asian Games athletics medal; first Indian female to win a Paralympic medal |
| Major honours mentioned                               | Khel Ratna, Arjuna Award and Padma Shri                                                                               |
| Areas she supports                                    | Emotional health of persons with challenges and empowerment of women through outdoor sports                           |

### II. Fact–opinion and cause–effect

A **fact** can be verified from evidence; an **opinion** expresses an interpretation, evaluation or belief. A **cause–effect** pair links an event/reason to its result. The chapter asks students to distinguish these relationships rather than treating every statement as a fact.

## 7. CRITICAL REFLECTION – EXTRACTS

The extract questions test how Dr. Malik's experiences support the chapter's central ideas: resilience, self-belief, changing perceptions and inclusion. For extract answers, identify the exact idea in the given lines and then explain it briefly rather than merely repeating the passage.

### Model extract answers

- **Dr. Malik's achievements:** They show that a major physical setback did not end her sporting aspirations; she developed new possibilities through training and determination.
- **"Ability beyond disability":** The phrase shifts attention from limitation to capability and opportunity.
- **Changing perceptions:** Success by women and para-athletes can challenge stereotypes about who can participate and excel in sport.
- **Advocacy:** Her public work extends the impact of sport beyond medals to awareness, inclusion and opportunities for others.

## 8. LONG-ANSWER SOLUTIONS

### Q1. How do Dr. Malik's achievements challenge societal perceptions?

Dr. Malik's achievements challenge the assumption that disability should determine a person's ambitions or social role. After becoming paralysed waist-down, she entered para-sport, competed at the highest level and won a Paralympic silver medal. Her journey also challenges gender stereotypes by demonstrating that women with disabilities can participate in demanding competitive and adventure activities. Her achievements therefore broaden society's understanding of ability, opportunity and participation.

## Q2. What may be the long-term impact of involving youth in advocacy?

Young people who learn about inclusion can carry those ideas into schools, workplaces and communities. They may become more sensitive to accessibility, reject stereotypes, support equal participation and influence institutions to make opportunities more inclusive. The effect can therefore extend beyond one awareness programme into future social attitudes and practices.

## Q3. Why is the title appropriate?

The title suggests that possibilities do not end where physical limitations begin. Dr. Malik's journey repeatedly demonstrates this idea: a life-changing medical condition becomes the beginning of a new sporting and social journey. The title therefore captures the chapter's emphasis on potential, courage and opportunity.

## Q4. Explain: "Every setback is an opportunity to prove your strength."

A setback may close one path without closing every path. A person can assess the new situation, adapt, learn new skills and continue towards meaningful goals. The statement is relevant to students as well as sportspersons because academic difficulties, failures or unexpected changes can become opportunities for reflection, persistence and improvement.

## Q5. How does recognition as an inspirational para-athlete contribute to gender equality in sport?

Recognition makes women's achievements more visible and can challenge the idea that high-level sport belongs mainly to men. When women with disabilities receive public recognition for sporting excellence, they become visible examples of participation and leadership. This can encourage institutions and families to create more opportunities for girls and women in sport.

## Q6. How can "ability beyond disability" guide future para-athletes?

It encourages athletes to focus on skills, goals and possibilities rather than allowing a disability to become the sole definition of identity. It also suggests that society should provide appropriate training, accessibility and opportunities so that ability can be developed fully.

## Q7. What have you learnt and how can you apply it?

I have learnt that limitations need not determine ambition. I can apply this lesson by setting realistic goals, working consistently, adapting when difficulties arise, avoiding stereotypes about other people and supporting inclusive participation. I should judge progress by effort, learning and improvement rather than by comparison alone.

# 9. VOCABULARY & STRUCTURES

## Useful phrase meanings

| Phrase                | Meaning                                      | Example                                             |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| push one's boundaries | try to go beyond one's usual limits          | She pushed her boundaries through regular training. |
| overcome a challenge  | successfully deal with a difficulty          | He overcame the challenge through practice.         |
| break a stereotype    | challenge a fixed social assumption          | Her achievement broke a common stereotype.          |
| make a difference     | produce a meaningful effect                  | Accessible sport can make a difference.             |
| rise to the occasion  | respond effectively to a difficult situation | She rose to the occasion under pressure.            |

## Movement vocabulary

Sprint, dash, race, charge, rush, stride, jog, stumble, stagger, crawl and leap describe different forms or qualities of movement. Context determines whether movement is fast, slow, controlled, difficult or sudden.

# 10. MODAL AUXILIARIES

| Modal | Common function                             | Example                                |
|-------|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| can   | ability / possibility                       | She can inspire others.                |
| could | past ability / possibility / polite request | She could adapt to a new challenge.    |
| may   | possibility / permission                    | The event may encourage participation. |

| Modal  | Common function                                  | Example                                |
|--------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| might  | less certain possibility                         | It might change attitudes.             |
| should | advice / expectation                             | Schools should promote inclusion.      |
| would  | polite request / imagined situation / past habit | She would continue despite difficulty. |
| must   | strong necessity                                 | Facilities must be accessible.         |

## 11. REPORTED SPEECH – MODEL SOLUTIONS

- Direct: Dr. Malik said, "I can continue training." → Reported: Dr. Malik said that she could continue training.
- Direct: The interviewer said, "You have inspired many people." → Reported: The interviewer said that she had inspired many people.
- Direct: She said, "We must create opportunities." → Reported: She said that they must create opportunities.
- Direct: The student asked, "Can para-athletes compete internationally?" → Reported: The student asked whether para-athletes could compete internationally.

## 12. LISTEN AND RESPOND – SPECIAL ASSEMBLY

The listening text announces a special assembly for World Inclusion Day. Key details are: **Thursday, 10 October; 9.00 a.m.; school auditorium; welcome speech by the Principal; staging on inclusion by the Interact Club; special dance performance; panel discussion with inclusion advocates; concluding song by students.** These details match the current Unit 5 listening transcript. ■cite■turn0search22■

## 13. WRITING TASK – NOTICE

**VERCHAS ACADEMY**

**NOTICE**

**INTER-SCHOOL ATHLETIC MEET – SELECTION TRIALS**

Students interested in participating in sprint, middle-distance, relay, long jump and other athletic events are invited to register for selection trials. Submit your name, class and preferred event to the Sports Club by 25 September. Trials will be held on 28 September at 8:00 a.m. on the school ground.

**Sports Captain**

## 14. ADDITIONAL EXAM QUESTIONS

### Q1. Why is the interview format effective for this chapter?

An interview allows the reader to encounter the athlete's ideas in a direct question-and-answer form. It makes personal experiences, motivations and advice accessible while also giving the chapter a clear informational structure.

### Q2. How are resilience and inclusion connected?

Individual resilience helps a person continue despite obstacles, while inclusion helps society remove unnecessary obstacles and create equal opportunities. The chapter presents both: personal determination and social support are important for meaningful participation.

### Q3. Why should society focus on accessibility rather than only inspiration?

Inspiration can change attitudes, but accessibility creates practical opportunity. Ramps, suitable equipment, transport, training facilities and inclusive policies allow people to participate rather than merely being admired from a distance.

## 15. MCQs

**Dr. Deepa Malik is presented primarily as a**

- A. novelist
- B. para-athlete

- C. musician
- D. scientist

Answer: B

**She was diagnosed with a spinal tumour at the age of**

- A. 19
- B. 24
- C. 29
- D. 39

Answer: C

**The surgery resulted in paralysis**

- A. waist-down
- B. of one arm only
- C. of both hands
- D. temporarily

Answer: A

**At Rio 2016 she won**

- A. gold
- B. silver
- C. bronze
- D. no medal

Answer: B

**The chapter repeatedly emphasizes**

- A. wealth
- B. ability beyond disability
- C. competition alone
- D. fame

Answer: B

**Resilience means**

- A. giving up
- B. recovering/adapting after difficulty
- C. avoiding effort
- D. ignoring others

Answer: B

**Inclusion means**

- A. exclusion from activities
- B. equal meaningful participation
- C. competition without rules
- D. isolation

Answer: B

**A fact is a statement that**

- A. can be verified
- B. is always emotional
- C. expresses only a belief
- D. is a slogan

Answer: A

**A cause–effect relationship connects**

- A. two unrelated ideas
- B. a reason and its result

- C. two synonyms
- D. two questions

Answer: B

**The chapter uses which text type?**

- A. interview
- B. drama
- C. diary
- D. fable

Answer: A

**Which modal commonly expresses advice?**

- A. should
- B. did
- C. has
- D. was

Answer: A

**Which award is associated with Dr. Malik in the chapter?**

- A. Padma Shri
- B. Booker Prize
- C. Oscar
- D. Jnanpith

Answer: A

## 16. EXAM-WRITING TIP

For long answers, use the pattern point → evidence from the interview → explanation → concluding idea. Avoid merely praising the personality; connect each answer to a specific event, statement or idea from the chapter.